CROONING GLORY

Arijit Singh and Shreya Ghoshal continue to reign supreme with multiple chartbusters

By SUHANI SINGH


AFP

Q. Who is India's No. 1 male singer?

1 ARIJIT SINGH **37.1** [38.3]


2 SONU NIGAM **13.3** [12.2]


3 UDIT NARAYAN **11.2** [10.8]


4 JUBIN NAUTIYAL **5.5** [5.4]


5 SHANKAR MAHADEVAN **4.6** [5.4]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 female singer?

1 SHREYA GHOSHAL **36.8** [39.6]


HINDUSTAN TIMES


2 ALKA YAGNIK **11.9** [10.7]


3 NEHA KAKKAR **11.6** [12.1]


4 SUNIDHI CHAUHAN **6.8** [7.2]


5 SHILPA RAO **5.7** [4.8]

All figures in %; rest, others; Aug. '24 figures in bold, Feb. '24 in [ ]

Two of Indian cinema's highest-paid, most talented and most sought-after voices, Arijit Singh and Shreya Ghoshal, comfortably topped the India Today Mood of the Nation charts yet again. That the two also feature in the year-ending chart of most-streamed artists comes as no surprise. After all, a year doesn't go by in Hindi film music without the two delivering an earworm that strikes a chord. The year 2024 is no different. Arijit has already sung one of 2024's most acclaimed songs—the moving 'Vida Karo' (*Amar Singh Chamkila*)—and won his second National Award for 'Kesariya', still the defining ballad for Gen Z. Meanwhile, Shreya continues to make waves this year with her sonorous renditions, be it in Hindi ('Dheeme Dheeme' from *Laapataa Ladies*) or Telugu ('Sooseki' from *Pushpa 2*).

What's noteworthy is how the golden voices from the 1990s and 2000s refuse to fade away, with Sonu Nigam, Udit Narayan and Alka Yagnik holding high ranks in the MOTN poll. Sonu, in particular, has seen a career renaissance in the past few years, having sung for film soundtracks like *Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahani*, *Animal* and *Dunki*. Also featuring in the top five are Neha Kakkar, the highest followed artist on Instagram with 79 million followers, and Shilpa Rao, whose distinct, husky voice is behind chartbusters like 'Besharam Rang' and 'Kaavaalaa'. ■